

Northbridge University Academic Regulations

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IMPORTANT: This is a completely fictional university policy created only for software development, demonstrations, testing, retrieval evaluation, and learning. It is not an official policy of any real institution.

Institution

Northbridge University is a fictional institution used only to provide realistic sample content for the Student Support Copilot project.

Purpose and Scope

This fictional document summarises academic regulations relating to attendance, assessment submission, extensions, academic integrity, mitigating circumstances, progression, appeals, suspension, and withdrawal.

1. Attendance and Engagement

Students are expected to participate in scheduled learning activities and engage with required academic work.

- The normal minimum attendance expectation for scheduled in-person teaching is 80 percent unless a programme has a stricter professional requirement.
- Students who fall below the expected level may be contacted by the programme team and offered an academic-support meeting.
- Attendance alone does not guarantee progression or module success.

2. Coursework Submission

Coursework must be submitted through the approved platform by the published deadline.

- The official submission time is the timestamp recorded by the university submission system.
- Students are responsible for confirming that the correct file was uploaded successfully.
- A corrupted or unreadable file may be treated as a non-submission unless the student can demonstrate a system problem.

3. Late Submission

Work submitted after the deadline without an approved extension is subject to the fictional late-work rules.

- Work submitted up to 24 hours late receives a maximum mark of 40 percent when it would otherwise have passed.
- Work submitted more than 24 hours late is normally recorded as a non-submission and receives zero, unless an approved exception applies.
- Programme-specific professional requirements may use stricter rules.

4. Extensions

A short extension may be requested where an unexpected circumstance affects the student shortly before a coursework deadline.

- Extension requests should normally be submitted before the original deadline.
- A standard short extension is up to 5 calendar days.
- Evidence may be required depending on the reason and length requested.
- Approval is not automatic, and the revised deadline must be confirmed in writing.

5. Academic Integrity and Plagiarism

Students must submit work that accurately represents their own contribution and appropriately acknowledges sources and permitted assistance.

- Copying text, code, data, images, or ideas without appropriate acknowledgement may constitute plagiarism.
- Submitting another person's work as one's own is prohibited.
- Using Generative AI in an assessment is allowed only where the assessment instructions explicitly permit it and the student follows the stated acknowledgement rules.
- Suspected misconduct is investigated through a formal process; the chatbot cannot determine guilt.

6. Mitigating Circumstances

Mitigating circumstances are serious, unexpected, and normally temporary events that significantly affect assessment performance or participation.

- Applications should normally be submitted within 5 working days of the affected assessment.
- Students should provide relevant evidence where reasonably possible.
- Long-term difficulties should normally be discussed with Student Support or Accessibility Services rather than repeatedly managed only through short-term mitigation.

7. Academic Progression

Progression is determined from confirmed module results and programme-specific requirements.

- Students normally need sufficient credit and any required core-module passes to progress.
- A progression board may permit conditional progression where a limited amount of reassessment remains.
- Repeated failure may result in a requirement to repeat a level, transfer programme, or withdraw, subject to formal review.

8. Academic Appeals

Students may appeal an academic decision only on specified grounds.

- Potential grounds include material procedural error, relevant mitigating circumstances that could not reasonably have been disclosed earlier, or significant administrative error.
- Disagreement with academic judgement is not itself a valid ground of appeal.
- The normal fictional appeal deadline is 10 working days after notification of the decision.
- Students should identify the decision being challenged and provide evidence supporting the stated ground.

9. Suspension of Studies

A temporary suspension may be considered where a student cannot continue study for an extended period.

- Students should discuss the implications with the programme office before applying.
- The normal maximum initial suspension period is one academic year.
- Return from suspension may require confirmation that the student can resume study and meet programme requirements.

10. Withdrawal from the University

A student who decides to leave the university should complete the formal withdrawal process.

- The effective withdrawal date may affect fees, funding, immigration status, accommodation, and access to university systems.
- Students should seek appropriate advice before submitting the final withdrawal request.
- Failure to attend classes does not by itself complete formal withdrawal.

Quick Reference Questions

These examples restate the policy in common student language. They remain fictional and are included to support retrieval testing.

What is the normal attendance expectation?

This fictional regulation uses an 80 percent minimum expectation for scheduled in-person teaching unless a programme specifies a stricter requirement.

What happens if I submit coursework 12 hours late?

Without an approved extension, work submitted up to 24 hours late is capped at 40 percent when it would otherwise have passed.

How long is a standard short extension?

The fictional standard short extension is up to 5 calendar days.

Can I appeal because I think the marker was too harsh?

Disagreement with academic judgement alone is not a valid appeal ground in this fictional policy.

Document Control

Owner: Academic and Student Services Office (fictional). Review cycle: annual. This document must not be used to make decisions for students at a real institution.